

MVP Decisions & Task Board Mapping:

UniConnect

Context:

Our project is a web-based student group chat platform designed to centralize academic life. We observed that while WhatsApp is great for quick location sharing, it lacks structure. Discord offers excellent channel organization but lacks academic tools. Microsoft Teams provides timetables but is overly complex and "cold" for student life. UniConnect adopts the best of these three to create a welcoming, structured, and utility-driven "Digital Campus."

Part 1 — Adopt Decisions (3)

Adopt #1: Server-based Channels (Discord-style)

- **Source:** Example 2 (Discord)
- **Decision:** We will implement fixed channels (e.g., #General, #Announcements, #Resources) within the class group.
- **Why:** Discord's structure is the best for avoiding message overload. By separating "Chat" from "Announcements," students can find critical info without scrolling through hundreds of casual messages.
- **Where:** Left Sidebar; accessible immediately after login.
- **Constraint:** Only text channels for MVP; no voice/video rooms.

Adopt #2: Integrated Academic Timetable (Teams-style)

- **Source:** Example 3 (Microsoft Teams)
- **Decision:** We will implement a weekly grid view that displays official courses and student-organized study sessions.
- **Why:** Unlike Discord or WhatsApp, Teams is efficient because the schedule is *inside* the app. We will adopt this but with a more "welcoming UI" to improve the student experience.
- **Where:** Timetable Page (timetable.html); accessible via the sidebar.
- **Constraint:** Static timetable managed by the Professor/Admin role.

Adopt #3: Event Location Metadata & UI Style (WhatsApp-style)

- **Source:** WhatsApp

- **Decision:** We will allow users to attach a specific location string (Room number or Address) and a "Open in Maps" link to every created event. And design our application in a similar style (simple, clear and modern)
- **Why:** WhatsApp users love location sharing for its clarity. Applying this to school events (like a "Revision Session") ensures students know exactly where to go without asking. Same for UI.
- **Where:** Event Creation Form and Event Cards on the Timetable.
- **Constraint:** Static address text + external map link; no live GPS tracking.

Part 2 — Avoid Decisions (3)

Avoid #1: Real-time Voice and Video Calls

- **Source:** Discord/Teams have this, but it adds massive technical debt.
- **Decision:** We will NOT implement WebRTC voice/video.
- **Why:** It requires complex server infrastructure and high bandwidth that exceed MVP timeframes.
- **Replacement:** High-quality real-time text chat via WebSockets for all channels.

Avoid #2: Full Assignment Submission & Grading System

- **Source:** Teams has a complex "Assignments" module.
- **Decision:** We will NOT implement file uploads for student submissions or grading.
- **Why:** Handling file security and teacher grading workflows is too risky.
- **Replacement:** A "Resource List" where teachers post task descriptions and PDFs for students to view.

Avoid #3: Advanced Role Permissions (Discord-level)

- **Source:** Discord allows hundreds of custom permission combinations.
- **Decision:** We will NOT implement a custom role-creator.
- **Why:** Hardcoding roles is faster and more stable for an MVP.
- **Replacement:** Four fixed roles: Administrator, Professor, Delegate, and Student.

Part 3 — Multimedia Decisions (2)

Multimedia #1: Animated "New Message" Indicator

- **What:** A pulsing CSS-animated Indigo dot next to channel names.

- **Purpose:** Improves navigation clarity by alerting students to unread official announcements while they are on the Timetable or Election pages.
- **Placement:** Sidebar; next to channel labels. Triggers on a WebSocket "new_msg" event.
- **Technical Approach:** CSS @keyframes pulse.

Multimedia #2: Election Success "Confetti Burst"

- **What:** A full-screen burst of colorful particles + an animated SVG green checkmark.
- **Purpose:** Provides "Happy Path" feedback to the student, confirming their vote is recorded.
- **Placement:** election.html; triggers on the "Confirm Vote" click.
- **Technical Approach:** canvas-confetti JS library and CSS stroke-dashoffset for the checkmark.

Part 4 — MVP Scope Lock

MVP Features (Exactly 7):

1. **Auth:** Role-based Login/Register.
2. **Groups:** Admin Panel to manage class rosters.
3. **Chat:** Real-time text channels.
4. **Announcements:** Official read-only feed for Professors.
5. **Timetable:** Weekly grid with Course/Event overlay.
6. **Elections:** Delegate voting system with success animation.
7. **Events:** Creation of events (study or fun).

Out of Scope for MVP:

- Voice/Video calls.
- Assignment submission/file uploads for students.
- Real-time GPS routing.

Part 5 — Task Board Items

ID	Task Name	Owner	Definition of Done (DoD)
T1	Sidebar Navigation (Adopt #1)	Laurick	Sidebar links correctly load Chat, Timetable, and Election HTML pages.
T2	Timetable Grid (Adopt #2)	Nihad	Weekly grid renders with courses; student events appear in different colors.
T3	Event Location Field (Adopt #3)	Rashad	"Location" field added to event form; "Open in Maps" link works.

T4	Scope Lock: Call Buttons (Avoid #1)	Laurick	Chat UI contains no camera/phone icons; decisions updated in docs.
T5	Scope Lock: Task List (Avoid #2)	Nihad	Assignment page is "view-only"; no submission/upload buttons exist.
T6	Scope Lock: Role Enum (Avoid #3)	Rashad	Database uses fixed "Student/Prof" roles; no role-creation UI exists.
T7	Create New Message Anim (Multi #1)	Kristen	CSS pulse class created; dot appears on sidebar when message is received.
T8	Success Checkmark & Confetti (Multi #2)	Kristen	Animation triggers on vote submit; success view replaces the voting form.
T9	Freeze MVP Scope (Required)	Coordinator	MVP and Out-of-scope lists finalized; team review date added.